

KEY TOPIC 1
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EXAM TERMINOLOGY VAULT:

IDF Founded

700,000 Palestinian Refugees

ROOT CAUSES & IMPERIAL BETRAYAL

TRIGGER:	Britain sought wartime alliances, promising independence to Arab leaders (McMahon-Hussein) while secretly negotiating partition with France.
ACTION:	Foreign Secretary Arthur Balfour committed Britain to supporting a "national home for the Jewish people" in Palestine without prejudicing existing civil rights.
CONSEQUENCE:	Created an irreconcilable imperial conflict between Arab national self-determination and growing Jewish Zionist immigration under the League of Nations Mandate.

declaration of sympathy with Jewish Zionist aspirations which had been submitted to, and approved by, the Council.

This ~~document~~ Government view with favour: the establishment in Palestine of a national home for the Jewish people, and will use their best endeavours to facilitate the achievement of this object. It being clearly understood that nothing shall be done which may prejudice the civil and religious rights of existing non-Jewish communities in Palestine, or the rights and political status enjoyed by Jews in any other country.

Original 1917 Balfour Declaration letter.

JEWISH INSURGENCY & BRITISH EXHAUSTION

TRIGGER:	British restrictions on post-Holocaust Jewish immigration and the arrest of Zionist leaders (Operation Agatha).
ACTION:	Militants from the Irgun (led by Menachem Begin) detonated milk churns packed with explosives in the basement, killing 91 British, Arab, and Jewish staff.
CONSEQUENCE:	Shattered British political will to govern Palestine, leading directly to Foreign Secretary Ernest Bevin handing the Mandate to the United Nations in February 1947.



The collapsed south-west wing housing British...

INTERNATIONAL PRESSURE & MORAL COLLAPSE

TRIGGER: The British Royal Navy blockaded Palestine, forcing 4,500 Holocaust survivors aboard the SS Exodus back to detention camps in post-war Germany.

ACTION: Irgun militants abducted and hanged two British intelligence sergeants (Paice and Martin) in retaliation for British executions of Irgun fighters.

CONSEQUENCE: Triggered anti-Jewish riots across British cities and convinced British public opinion that staying in Palestine was morally untenable and too costly.



The Sergeants Affair
Bodies of two execute

THE DIPLOMATIC CATALYST FOR WAR

TRIGGER:	UNSCOP investigated Palestine and concluded that joint Jewish-Arab power-sharing within a single state was impossible.
ACTION:	The UN General Assembly voted to partition Palestine into independent Arab and Jewish states, placing Jerusalem under international UN trusteeship.
CONSEQUENCE:	Jewish Agency accepted partition; Arab Higher Committee and Arab League rejected it outright, immediately triggering civil war between Jewish and Arab militias.



UN Resolution 181 map allocating 55% of Palestin...

THE 1948 WAR OF SURVIVAL / INDEPENDENCE

TRIGGER:	The final British High Commissioner departed Haifa, terminating the 26-year British Mandate.
ACTION:	David Ben-Gurion read the Israeli Declaration of Independence; armies from five Arab nations (Egypt, Jordan, Syria, Iraq, Lebanon) invaded the next morning.
CONSEQUENCE:	Haganah mobilized into the Israel Defense Forces (IDF); superior coordination, Czechoslovak arms, and motivation enabled Israel to survive and seize the initiative.



David Ben-Gurion
declaring Israeli...

TERRITORIAL CHANGES & THE REFUGEE PROBLEM

TRIGGER:	Arab military disunity and the June 1948 UN truce enabled the newly formed IDF to rearm with foreign weapons and launch decisive counter-offensives.
ACTION:	The 1949 Armistice Agreements redrew borders: Israel expanded to hold 78% of Mandatory Palestine; Jordan annexed the West Bank and Egypt held Gaza.
CONSEQUENCE:	Over 700,000 Palestinian Arabs became refugees in neighbouring Arab states; Israel refused their return, while Arab states refused permanent integration, creating an enduring crisis.



Palestinian refugees
fleeing during the 1948-4...

Continuous analytical progression for Edexcel Paper 2 Question 2

5. Results of 1948–49 War
5 1949 armistice agreements gave Israel 78% of territory, creating 700,000...

Refugee Problem: The displacement of over 700,000 Palestinian Arabs who fled or were expelled during the 1948–49 war.

KEY TOPIC 2: Increased Tension, Crises and Conflict, 1955–1973

KEY TOPIC 2

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Lessons KT 1.3, KT 2.1, KT 2.2 & KT 2.3 • Suez Crisis, Six-Day War, Rise of Palestinian Resistance & Yom Kippur War

EXAM TERMINOLOGY VAULT:

Pan-Arabism

Suez Nationalisation

Protocol of Sèvres

UAR (1958)

1964 Cairo Conference

Fatah & PLO

River Jordan Water Dispute

Samu Raid (1966)

Pre-emptive Strike

Operation Focus

Occupied Territories

UN Resolution 242

Khartoum "Three Noes"

PFLP Hijacks

Black September

Munich 1972

Bar Lev Line

OPEC Oil Embargo

July – Nov 1956

ANTI-COLONIAL DEFIANCE & PAN-ARABISM

The Suez Crisis & The Rise of Gamal Abdel Nasser

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

US and Britain cancelled funding for Egypt's Aswan High Dam after Nasser bought Soviet Czech weapons.

The Arab League established the **Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO)**; Yasser Arafat's **Fatah** movement launched cross-border fedayeen raids backed by Syria.

US President Eisenhower forced Anglo-French withdrawal via economic sanctions; Nasser became hero of **Pan-Arabism**; UNEF placed in Sinai.



President Gamal Abdel Nasser, hero of Pan-Arab...

13–17 January 1964

ARAB MOBILISATION & GUERRILLA WARFARE

The Cairo Conference & The Creation of the PLO

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

Disputes erupted over Israeli diversion of River Jordan waters; Arab states met to organize military and diplomatic opposition.

The Arab League established the **Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO)**; Yasser Arafat's **Fatah** movement launched cross-border fedayeen raids backed by Syria.

Escalated border clashes with Israel (e.g. 1966 Samu raid and 7 April 1967 air battle over Golan), accelerating the slide into the 1967 war.



Arab leaders convened in Cairo in 1964 to counter...

5–10 June 1967

THE DECISIVE TERRITORIAL CATAclySM

The Six-Day War: Pre-emptive Triumph & Conquered Territories

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

Nasser expelled UNEF peacekeepers, remilitarised Sinai, closed Straits of Tiran, and signed joint defense pact with Jordan.

Israel launched **Operation Focus** pre-emptive air strikes, destroying Arab air forces in 3 hours, then crushed Egyptian, Jordanian, and Syrian ground armies.

Israel captured the **Sinai Peninsula, Gaza Strip, West Bank, East Jerusalem, and Golan Heights**, placing 1 million Palestinians under military occupation.



David Rubinger's iconic photograph of Israeli...

22 November 1967

THE "LAND FOR PEACE" DOCTRINE

UN Security Council Resolution 242

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

International community scrambled to establish a durable legal formula to resolve the territorial outcome of the Six-Day War.

UNSC unanimously passed Resolution 242: called for Israeli withdrawal from occupied territories in exchange for Arab recognition and peace.

Became the permanent diplomatic benchmark ("**Land for Peace**"); Arab League responded with the "**Three Noes**" of Khartoum (no peace, no recognition, no negotiation).



Map of the Conquered Territories establishing th...

September 1970

PALESTINIAN MILITANCY & THE PFLP

Black September & The PFLP Airplane Hijackings

TRIGGER:

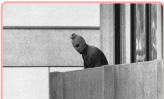
ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

The PLO and PFLP operated as a "state within a state" in Jordan, launching fedayeen raids and hijacking Western airliners to Dawson's Field.

King Hussein ordered the Jordanian Army to crush Palestinian militia strongholds in Amman, killing thousands of fighters and civilians.

The PLO leadership was expelled to Southern Lebanon ("**Fatahland**"); radical splinter group **Black September** formed, orchestrating the 1972 Munich Olympic massacre.



A Black September militant on the balcony at the 197...

6–25 October 1973

SHATTERING ISRAELI COMPLACENCY

The Yom Kippur War: Operation Badr & The OPEC Oil Embargo

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

Egypt and Syria sought to break the diplomatic stalemate, erase the humiliation of 1967, and regain the Sinai and Golan Heights.

Launched surprise coordinated assault on Yom Kippur; Egyptian troops breached the Bar Lev Line under a Soviet SAM anti-aircraft umbrella.

Shattered Israeli myth of invincibility; Arab OPEC ministers launched an **Oil Embargo** quadrupling world oil prices; forced US into emergency shuttle diplomacy.



Egyptian infantry using high-pressure water...

EXAM SKILL: 8-MARK NARRATIVE CAUSATION CHAIN

Continuous analytical progression for Edexcel Paper 2 Question 2

1. Suez & Nasserism

2. Cairo & PLO Inception

3. Six-Day War Cataclysm

4. Res 242 & Militancy

5. Yom Kippur & Oil Shock

KEY SPECIFICATION GLOSSARY:

Pan-Arabism: Ideology championed by Nasser promoting political, cultural, and military unity among all Arab nations.

Pre-emptive Strike: Military attack launched to forestall or neutralize an enemy's imminent offensive (e.g. Operation Focus 1967).

Resolution 242: UN resolution establishing "Land for Peace": Israeli withdrawal in return for Arab recognition.

Bar Lev Line: Heavily fortified Israeli sand-rampart defensive chain built along the east bank of the Suez Canal after 1967.

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Lesson KT 3.1 • Yasser Arafat at the UN, Kissinger's Shuttle Diplomacy & The Egypt–Israel Peace Treaty

EXAM TERMINOLOGY VAULT:	Shuttle Diplomacy	Henry Kissinger	Suez Reopened (1975)	Yasser Arafat at UN	"Olive Branch & Gun"	Anwar Sadat	Kneset Address (1977)	Menachem Begin
	Jimmy Carter	Camp David Accords (1978)	Sinai Demilitarisation	Treaty of Washington (1979)	Arab League Boycott	Sadat Assassination (1981)	Peace Treaty Survives	

13 November 1974

DIPLOMATIC LEGITIMACY OF THE PLO

Yasser Arafat Addresses the UN General Assembly

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

Arab League summit at Rabat recognized the PLO as the "sole legitimate representative of the Palestinian people".
Arafat addressed the UN wearing a holster: *"Do not let the olive branch fall from my hand."* The UN granted the PLO observer status.
Elevated the Palestinian national cause from a mere refugee issue into a recognized global political struggle for sovereign statehood.

1974–1975

STEP-BY-STEP DIPLOMATIC REALISM

Kissinger's "Shuttle Diplomacy" & Reopening of the Suez Canal

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

The superpower nuclear alert during the Yom Kippur War convinced Washington that regional stability was a vital US strategic priority.
US Secretary of State Henry Kissinger flew between Cairo, Tel Aviv, and Damascus negotiating disengagement pacts; Egypt reopened Suez Canal in June 1975.
Separated Israeli and Egyptian armies along the canal, restored international shipping, and detached Egypt from the Soviet sphere of influence.

19–20 November 1977

THE PSYCHOLOGICAL BREAKTHROUGH

President Anwar Sadat's Historic Journey to Jerusalem

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

Sadat realized that Egypt's fragile economy could no longer sustain war, and that only peace could recover the oil-rich Sinai Peninsula.
Sadat made the electrifying announcement that he was ready to travel to Israel; he addressed the Kneset, recognizing Israel's existence.
Demolished the 30-year psychological wall of mutual hatred, paving the way for direct bilateral negotiations hosted by US President Jimmy Carter.

5–17 September 1978

THE HISTORIC FRAMEWORK FOR PEACE

The Camp David Accords

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

Talks stalled over Israeli withdrawal from Sinai settlements and Palestinian autonomy in the West Bank and Gaza.
President Carter isolated Begin and Sadat for 13 intense days at Camp David, drafting the **Framework for Peace in the Middle East**.
Agreed on full Israeli withdrawal from Sinai in return for Egyptian diplomatic recognition, but left Palestinian autonomy vague and unfulfilled.

26 March 1979

THE FIRST ARAB-ISRAELI PEACE TREATY

The Washington Treaty: Egypt-Israel Peace Treaty Signed

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

Final legal formalization of the Camp David Accords backed by billions of dollars in US economic and military aid to both nations.
Sadat and Begin signed the formal peace treaty in Washington, establishing full diplomatic relations and normalizing trade.
Israel neutralized its most formidable military opponent; Egypt recovered all Sinai; Arab League expelled Egypt and moved HQ to Tunis.

6 October 1981

CONSEQUENCES OF THE 1979 PEACE TREATY

The Assassination of Anwar Sadat & The Arab Boycott

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

Arab nations strongly condemned Egypt for signing a separate peace that ignored the Palestinians, expelling Egypt from the Arab League.
In October 1981, President Anwar Sadat was assassinated by Egyptian soldiers who fiercely opposed the peace treaty with Israel.
Despite Sadat's assassination and Arab boycotts, the peace treaty held, permanently ending the threat of a major multi-front war for Israel.

EXAM SKILL: 8-MARK NARRATIVE CAUSATION CHAIN

Continuous analytical progression for Edexcel Paper 2 Question 2

1. Nuclear Alert to Shuttle Talks

1973 superpower faceoff forced US mediation, separating armies &...

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2. Diplomatic Rise of PLO

Arafat's UN speech transformed Palestinian issue from refugees into...

→

3. Sadat Shatters Deadlock

Historic 1977 Kneset visit convinced Israeli public that direct bilateral...

→

4. Camp David & Washington T...

Carter brokered historic treaty (1979): full Sinai return in exchange for full...

→

5. Arab Boycott & Sadat Assas...

Egypt was expelled from the Arab League and Sadat was assassinated...

KEY SPECIFICATION GLOSSARY:

Shuttle Diplomacy: Intense mediation involving travelling back and forth between rival capitals without direct face-to-face talks.

Kneset: The unicameral national parliament and legislative assembly of the State of Israel in Jerusalem.

Camp David Accords: 1978 peace agreements brokered by Jimmy Carter leading to the first Arab–Israeli peace treaty.

Cold Peace: State-to-state diplomatic peace without warm cultural, commercial, or public reconciliation.

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Lessons KT 3.2 & KT 3.3 • Operation Peace for Galilee, Sabra & Shatila, First Intifada & The Oslo Accords

EXAM TERMINOLOGY VAULT:

Operation Peace for Galilee

Ariel Sharon

Siege of Beirut (1982)

Sabra & Shatila Massacre

Kahan Commission

First Intifada (1987–93)

Jabalya Refugee Camp

UNLU

"Force, Might & Beatings"

Arafat Renounces Terrorism (1988)

Gulf War Coalition (1991)

End of Cold War

Oslo I Accords (1993)

Declaration of Principles

Palestinian Authority (PA)

1994 Israel-Jordan Treaty

Oslo II (Areas A, B, C)

Rabin Assassination (1995)

June – Sept 1982

THE WAR OF CHOICE & PLO EXPULSION

The 1982 Lebanon War (Operation Peace for Galilee)

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

Assassination attempt on Israeli ambassador Shlomo Argov in London by the Abu Nidal faction; ongoing cross-border PLO rocket attacks from southern Lebanon.
Defence Minister **Ariel Sharon** launched a full-scale invasion, advancing 60 miles north to surround and besiege the PLO leadership in West Beirut.
US-negotiated ceasefire evacuated 14,000 PLO fighters by sea to Tunis; shattered PLO military presence on Israel's northern border, but entangled IDF in Lebanon.

16–18 September 1982

MORAL CRISIS & ISRAELI DOMESTIC TURMOIL

The Sabra and Shatila Massacre & The Kahan Commission

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

Assassination of newly elected Lebanese Christian President Bachir Gemayel by Syrian-backed agents.
IDF permitted Christian Phalangist militia into the Sabra and Shatila refugee camps; Phalangists slaughtered up to 3,500 unarmed Palestinian refugees.
Huge anti-war protests (400,000 in Tel Aviv); Israel's **Kahan Commission** ruled Sharon bore "personal responsibility" for failing to prevent the slaughter, forcing his resignation.

December 1987

GRASSROOTS PALESTINIAN MASS RESISTANCE

Outbreak of the First Intifada (The Uprising of the Stones)

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

An Israeli military tank transport crashed into civilian cars at Jabalya Refugee Camp in Gaza, killing four Palestinian workers.
Spontaneous mass protests, strikes, boycotts, and stone-throwing erupted across Gaza and the West Bank, coordinated by the local **UNLU** (not Tunis PLO).
IDF policy of "force, might, and beatings" drew global media condemnation; convinced Israeli military leaders like Yitzhak Rabin that occupation could not be maintained by force.

1988–1991

DIPLOMATIC PIVOT & THE MADRID CONFERENCE

Arafat Renounces Terrorism & The Post-Cold War Realignment

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

The Intifada proved the Palestinian cause lived inside the territories; the 1991 Gulf War and Soviet collapse eliminated radical Arab/Soviet financial backing.
Arafat renounced terrorism at the UN in Geneva (1988); following US coalition victory in Kuwait, the US and USSR co-sponsored the landmark **Madrid Conference (1991)**.
Broke the taboo of face-to-face Arab-Israeli negotiations, creating the direct diplomatic momentum that led to secret Norwegian back-channel talks.

13 September 1993

HISTORIC MUTUAL RECOGNITION

The Oslo Accords (Declaration of Principles)

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

Secret back-channel talks in Oslo, Norway, enabled direct face-to-face bargaining between Israeli diplomats and PLO representatives.
Signed the **Declaration of Principles**: Israel and PLO officially recognized each other; established the **Palestinian National Authority (PA)** for interim self-rule in Gaza and Jericho.
Historic psychological breakthrough; rejected by extremist factions on both sides (Hamas launched suicide bus bombings; Israeli settlers protested).

1994–1995

PARTITION OF THE WEST BANK & THE TRAGIC CLIMAX

The Israel-Jordan Peace Treaty, Oslo II & Assassination of Rabin

TRIGGER:

ACTION:

CONSEQUENCE:

King Hussein of Jordan signed 1994 peace treaty; need to expand Palestinian self-rule into major West Bank towns.
Oslo II partitioned the West Bank into **Areas A, B, and C**. On 4 November 1995, Prime Minister **Yitzhak Rabin** was assassinated by Jewish extremist Yigal Amir.
West Bank remained fragmented under 60% direct Israeli military control (Area C); the peace process lost its principal Israeli architect, plunging the peace movement into crisis.

EXAM SKILL: 8-MARK NARRATIVE CAUSATION CHAIN

Continuous analytical progression for Edexcel Paper 2 Question 2

1

1. Lebanon Invasion & Moral Sh...
Sharon expelled PLO to Tunis (1982), but Sabra-Shatila massacre shattere...

→

2

2. Grassroots Intifada (1987)
Civilian stone-throwing vs IDF proved to Israeli generals that military...

→

3

3. Realignment & Madrid (1988...
Arafat renounced terrorism; 1991 Gulf War & Soviet collapse launched...

→

4

4. Oslo Accords & Self-Rule (19...
Secret back-channel produced mutual recognition & established Palestinian...

→

5

5. Oslo II & Rabin Murder (1995)
West Bank partitioned into Areas A, B & C; Hamas bombings & Rabin...

KEY SPECIFICATION GLOSSARY:

Intifada: Arabic for "shaking off": the mass Palestinian grassroots uprising against Israeli occupation (1987–1993).

UNLU: Unified National Leadership of the Uprising: the clandestine local leadership that coordinated strikes and protests.

Palestinian Authority: Interim administrative governing body established under the 1993 Oslo Accords to govern parts of West Bank and Gaza.

Areas A, B, and C: The 1995 territorial partition of the West Bank into Palestinian civil/security (A), joint control (B), and full Israeli control (C).

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